MODALES EN PASADO

Past modals · crítica, arrepentimiento y especulación

Nivel C1

Modal + have + participio mira al pasado para **criticar**, **lamentar** o **especular** sobre lo que pasó… o no pasó.

1 Crítica y arrepentimiento

- **should / ought to have** + participio = debería haber…
- You **should have told** me. (No lo hiciste.)
- I **shouldn't have shouted**. (Lo hice.)

2 ¿Hacía falta?

needn't have done = lo hice, pero no hacía falta

didn't need to do = no hacía falta (no lo hice)

I **needn't have cooked**: they'd eaten.

3 Posibilidad perdida

- **could have** + participio = podría haber…, pero no
- We **could have won**. (Pudimos ganar.)
- Reproche: You **could have called**!

4 Especulación

- **might / may / could have** = quizá…, puede que…
- She **may have missed** the train.
- Queja: You **might have** warned me!

5 Would have

- Lo que habría pasado (condición implícita)
- I **would have helped**, but nobody asked.
- Deseo frustrado: I'd **have liked** to go.

7 Error común

✗ You must have told me! (= deberías)

✓ You should have told me!

crítica → **should have** · **must have** = seguro que

6 Consejo rápido

- Siempre **have**: nunca ~~should of~~ ni ~~should had~~
- Continua: should have **been** + -ing
- Pasiva: should have **been** + participio

Mini ejercicio

Completa con un modal en pasado.
Complete with a past modal.

1. You _____ (tell) me! I'd have helped.
2. I _____ (buy) milk: we had plenty.
3. We _____ (win), but we didn't.
4. She _____ (miss) the bus. I'm not sure.
5. I _____ (like) to come, but I was ill.

Explicación · Explanation

Lee cada recuadro despacio. Primero en español, luego en inglés. Read each box slowly: first in Spanish, then in English.

¿Qué es? · What is it?

Los modales en pasado se forman siempre igual: **modal + have + participio**. Sirven para mirar atrás y opinar sobre lo ocurrido: **criticar** o **lamentar** (should have), señalar que algo **no hacía falta** (needn't have), hablar de **oportunidades perdidas** (could have), **especular** (might / may have) o imaginar lo que **habría pasado** (would have). Casi todos se refieren a algo que, en realidad, **no ocurrió**. Es una estructura clave en C1, tanto en conversación (reproches, disculpas) como en textos formales (informes, análisis de errores).

Past modals always follow the pattern modal + have + past participle. We use them to look back and comment: criticism, regret, unnecessary actions, missed opportunities, speculation and hypothetical results.

Modal + have + participio

should / ought to / needn't / could / might / may / would + have done

1 · Should have / ought to have · Criticism and regret

should have + participio (debería haber…) indica que algo era lo correcto pero no se hizo: sirve para **criticar** a otros o **lamentarnos**. En negativa, **shouldn't have** indica que algo **se hizo y estuvo mal**. **ought to have** significa lo mismo, con un matiz algo más formal o moral; su negativa, **oughtn't to have**, es poco frecuente. La expresión **I should have known** equivale a tendría que habérmelo imaginado.

should have + participle: the right thing didn't happen (criticism or regret). shouldn't have: it happened and it was a mistake. ought to have is similar, slightly more formal.

Sujeto + should have + participio

Sujeto + shouldn't have + participio

Sujeto + ought to have + participio

You **should have told** me you were coming — I'd have made dinner.
→ Deberías haberme dicho que venías: habría hecho la cena.

I **shouldn't have sent** that email in the heat of the moment.
→ No debería haber enviado ese correo en caliente.

The government **ought to have consulted** the unions before the reform.
→ El Gobierno debería haber consultado a los sindicatos antes de la reforma.

I **should have known** he wouldn't turn up.
→ Tendría que habérmelo imaginado: no iba a aparecer.

2 · Needn't have / didn't need to · Unnecessary actions

Esta es la gran sutileza del tema. **needn't have + participio** = lo hice, pero no hacía falta (esfuerzo inútil). **didn't need to + infinitivo** = no era necesario; normalmente significa que **no lo hice**, aunque el contexto puede indicar lo contrario (I didn't need to wait, but I did). **didn't have to** funciona igual que didn't need to. **needn't have** es más británico y algo más formal.

needn't have done: it was done, but it was unnecessary. didn't need to do: it wasn't necessary (and usually wasn't done).

needn't have + participio → lo hice (innecesario)

didn't need to + infinitivo → no hacía falta

You **needn't have brought** a present — but thank you!
→ No tenías que haber traído nada… ¡pero gracias!

I **needn't have revised** so much: the exam was a piece of cake.
→ No hacía falta que estudiara tanto: el examen estaba chupado.

We **didn't need to** book a table, so we just turned up.
→ No hacía falta reservar mesa, así que nos presentamos sin más.

NEEDN'T HAVE o DIDN'T NEED TO · needn't have vs didn't need to

Pregúntate: **¿se hizo la acción?** Si se hizo y fue inútil → **needn't have**. Si no se hizo porque no hacía falta → **didn't need to**.

Ask yourself: was the action actually done?

✅ Lo hice (en vano)

- I **needn't have taken** a taxi: the hotel was round the corner.
- Cogí un taxi, pero no hacía falta.
- She **needn't have worried**. (Se preocupó en vano.)

🚫 No lo hice

- I **didn't need to** take a taxi: Ana gave me a lift.
- No cogí taxi: no hacía falta.
- We **didn't have to** queue. (No hicimos cola.)

MODALES EN PASADO

Past modals · crítica, arrepentimiento y especulación

📖 Explicación · Explanation | Nivel C1

3 · Could have · Unrealised possibility

🇪🇸 **could have + participio** (podría haber…, pude haber…) habla de algo que **era posible pero no ocurrió**: oportunidades perdidas, peligros evitados o capacidades no aprovechadas. Con tono de queja es un **reproche**: You could have warned me! (¡podrías haberme avisado!). **couldn't have + comparativo** es enfático: I couldn't have been happier (no podría haber estado más feliz). Y **couldn't have** también expresa que algo era **imposible**: I couldn't have done it without you.

🇬🇧 could have + participle: possible, but it didn't happen; with a complaining tone it is a reproach. couldn't have + comparative is emphatic; couldn't have can also mean 'impossible'.

Sujeto + could have + participio

Sujeto + couldn't have + participio / comparativo

⚠️ That was reckless — you **could have been killed**!
→ Eso fue una imprudencia: ¡te podrías haber matado!

🎨 She **could have studied** medicine, but she chose fine art.
→ Podría haber estudiado Medicina, pero eligió Bellas Artes.

⏰ You **could have let** me know you'd be late!
→ ¡Podrías haberme avisado de que llegarías tarde!

🚀 The launch **couldn't have gone** better.
→ El lanzamiento no podría haber salido mejor.

4 · Might / may / could have · Speculating about the past

🇪🇸 Para **especular** sobre el pasado (quizá…, puede que…) usamos **might have, may have** o **could have** + participio. **may have** suena algo más formal. En negativa hay diferencia: **might not / may not have** = puede que no, pero **couldn't have** = es imposible que. Además, **might have** (no may) sirve para un **reproche irritado**: You might have told me! (Las deducciones seguras con **must have / can't have** se trabajan en B2.)

🇬🇧 might / may / could have: speculation about the past. might not have = perhaps not; couldn't have = impossible. might have can also express irritation.

Sujeto + might / may / could have + participio

Sujeto + might not / may not have + participio

🚂 He **might have missed** the train — that would explain why he isn't here.
→ Puede que haya perdido el tren: eso explicaría por qué no está aquí.

📁 The files **may have been deleted** by mistake.
→ Puede que los archivos se borraran por error.

✉️ She **might not have received** the invitation.
→ Puede que no recibiera la invitación.

😠 You **might have warned** me the boss was in a foul mood!
→ ¡Ya podrías haberme avisado de que el jefe estaba de un humor de perros!

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5 · Would have · What would have happened

🇪🇸 **would have + participio** (habría…) describe lo que **habría pasado o habríamos hecho** en otras circunstancias. Muchas veces la condición está **implícita** (but…, otherwise, in your position), sin if. Con verbos de deseo expresa un deseo frustrado: **I would have liked to** + infinitivo (me habría gustado). **wouldn't have** + participio expresa rechazo: I wouldn't have missed it for the world. (El third conditional completo se estudia en B2.)

🇬🇧 would have + participle: what would have happened in different circumstances, often with an implicit condition. I would have liked to… expresses an unfulfilled wish.

Sujeto + would have + participio (+ but / otherwise…)

I would have liked + to + infinitivo

🤝 I **would have helped** you, but you didn't ask.
→ Te habría ayudado, pero no me lo pediste.

💼 In your position, I **wouldn't have accepted** the offer.
→ En tu lugar, yo no habría aceptado la oferta.

✈️ **I'd have liked** to stay longer, but I had a flight to catch.
→ Me habría gustado quedarme más, pero tenía que coger un vuelo.

🚨 Luckily the alarm went off; otherwise we **would have lost** everything.
→ Por suerte saltó la alarma; si no, lo habríamos perdido todo.

¿Qué modal en pasado uso? · Which past modal?

1. ¿Algo **era lo correcto** y no se hizo (o se hizo mal)? → **should(n't) / ought to have.**
   🇬🇧 The right thing didn't happen → should / ought to have.
2. ¿Algo **innecesario**? Si se hizo → **needn't have** + participio. Si no se hizo → **didn't need to** + infinitivo.
   🇬🇧 Unnecessary: done → needn't have; not done → didn't need to.
3. ¿Una **oportunidad o un peligro** que no se materializó? → **could have.**
   🇬🇧 Missed chance or danger → could have.
4. ¿No sabes lo que pasó y **especulas**? → **might / may / could have.**
   🇬🇧 Speculation → might / may / could have.
5. ¿Qué **habría pasado** en otras circunstancias? → **would have.**
   🇬🇧 Hypothetical result → would have.
6. Construye: modal + **have** + participio (o **have been** + -ing / **have been** + participio).
   🇬🇧 Build: modal + have + participle (or have been + -ing / participle).

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Resumen: ¿qué modal uso? · Summary: which modal?

Modal + have + participio	Significado	Función	¿Ocurrió?	Ejemplo
should have / ought to have	debería haber	crítica, arrepentimiento	❌ no	You **should have asked**.
shouldn't have	no debería haber	crítica, arrepentimiento	✅ sí	I **shouldn't have laughed**.
needn't have	no hacía falta (y lo hice)	esfuerzo inútil	✅ sí	You **needn't have waited**.
didn't need to + infinitivo	no hacía falta	ausencia de necesidad	❌ normalmente no	I **didn't need to** wait.
could have	podría haber	posibilidad perdida, reproche	❌ no	We **could have won**.
might / may have	puede que / quizá	especulación	❓ no se sabe	She **may have left**.
might have (tono de queja)	ya podrías haber	reproche	❌ no	You **might have called**!
would have	habría	resultado hipotético	❌ no	I **would have come**.

Clave: casi todos los modales en pasado hablan de lo que **NO ocurrió**. Excepciones: **shouldn't have** y **needn't have** (sí ocurrió) y la especulación (no lo sabemos).

Most past modals refer to things that did NOT happen — except shouldn't have and needn't have (it did happen) and speculation (we don't know).

COULD HAVE o WAS ABLE TO · could have vs was able to

En afirmativa, **could have done** = podía, pero **no lo hice**. Para decir que **sí lo conseguí** en una ocasión concreta, usamos **was able to / managed to** (no could).

could have done = possible, but not done. was able to / managed to = actually done on a specific occasion.

could have · no lo hice

- We **could have reached** the summit, but the weather turned.
- Podríamos haber hecho cumbre, pero cambió el tiempo.

was able to · lo logré

- We **were able to** reach the summit before the storm.
- Conseguimos hacer cumbre antes de la tormenta.

MODALES EN PASADO

Past modals · crítica, arrepentimiento y especulación

📖 **Explicación** · Explanation | **Nivel C1**

Formas: simple, continua y pasiva · Simple, continuous and passive

Forma	Estructura	Ejemplo	Traducción
Simple	modal + have + participio	You should have **listened**.	Deberías haber escuchado.
Continua	modal + have been + -ing	You should have **been listening**.	Deberías haber estado escuchando.
Pasiva	modal + have been + participio	It should have **been checked**.	Debería haberse revisado.
Negativa	modal + not + have + participio	You **shouldn't have** said that.	No deberías haber dicho eso.
Pregunta	modal + sujeto + have + participio?	**Should** I **have** called?	¿Debería haber llamado?
Contracción oral	should've, could've, would've	I **should've** known.	Tendría que habérmelo imaginado.

Ojo: **should've** suena /ˈʃʊdəv/ y por eso hasta muchos nativos escriben ~~should of~~. ¡Es un error! Siempre **have**.

should've sounds like 'should of' — but it is always have.

Frases hechas muy británicas · Useful set phrases

- **You shouldn't have!** — ¡No tenías por qué! (al recibir un regalo)
- **I should have known.** — Tendría que habérmelo imaginado.
- **It could have been worse.** — Podría haber sido peor.
- **I could have kicked myself.** — Me habría dado de bofetadas.
- **You needn't have bothered.** — No hacía falta que te molestaras.
- **You might have said!** — ¡Ya podías haberlo dicho!
- **I wouldn't have missed it for the world.** — No me lo habría perdido por nada del mundo.
- **Who would have thought it?** — ¿Quién lo habría dicho?

Más ejemplos en contexto · More examples in context

- The project **should have been completed** by March.
  → El proyecto debería haberse terminado para marzo.
- You **shouldn't have been texting** while driving.
  → No deberías haber estado escribiendo mensajes mientras conducías.
- We **needn't have hurried**; the meeting started late.
  → No hacía falta que nos diéramos prisa: la reunión empezó tarde.
- Luckily, I **didn't need to** show my passport.
  → Por suerte, no tuve que enseñar el pasaporte.
- The accident **could have been avoided**.
  → El accidente se podría haber evitado.
- They **may have misunderstood** the instructions.
  → Puede que hayan entendido mal las instrucciones.
- I **would have called**, but my battery was dead.
  → Te habría llamado, pero me quedé sin batería.
- She **ought to have declared** the conflict of interest.
  → Debería haber declarado el conflicto de intereses.
- He **might have been** joking — it was hard to tell.
  → Puede que estuviera de broma; era difícil saberlo.
- **Should** I **have mentioned** the deadline earlier?
  → ¿Debería haber mencionado antes la fecha límite?
- With more funding, the study **could have reached** different conclusions.
  → Con más financiación, el estudio podría haber llegado a otras conclusiones.
- Nobody **would have guessed** she was nervous.
  → Nadie habría adivinado que estaba nerviosa.

¡Caza al monstruo! · Hunt the monster

Monstruo del error

✗ ~~You must have told me!~~ ~~(= deberías)~~
✓ You **should have** told me!
Crítica = should have. Must have = deducción (seguro que). / Criticism → should have, not must have.

✗ ~~You should told me.~~
✓ You should **have told** me.
Modal + have + participio: ¡no te comas el have! / Don't drop have.

✗ ~~You should had told me.~~
✓ You should **have** told me.
Tras un modal va have (infinitivo), nunca had. / After a modal: have, never had.

✗ ~~I should of called.~~
✓ I should **have** called.
Should've suena «should of», pero se escribe have. / It sounds like 'of', but it's have.

✗ ~~I didn't need to buy bread, so I wasted my money.~~
✓ I **needn't have bought** bread, so I wasted my money.
Lo compraste y fue inútil → needn't have. / Done but unnecessary → needn't have.

✗ ~~We could reach the summit after nine hours.~~
✓ We **were able to** reach the summit after nine hours.
Logro concreto en el pasado → was able to / managed to. / Specific achievement → was able to.

✗ ~~He mightn't have stolen it: he was abroad.~~ ~~(= imposible)~~
✓ He **couldn't have** stolen it: he was abroad.
Imposible → couldn't have. Might not = quizá no. / Impossible → couldn't have.

✗ ~~You ought have asked first.~~
✓ You ought **to have** asked first.
Ought siempre lleva to. / ought always takes to.

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📖 **Explicación** · Explanation

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Tras una reunión desastrosa · After a disastrous meeting

Clara Well, that could have gone better.
Bueno, eso podría haber salido mejor.

Jake I know. I should have checked the figures beforehand. The client spotted the error straight away.
Lo sé. Debería haber comprobado las cifras antes. El cliente vio el error enseguida.

Clara You might have told me you hadn't had time — I'd have done it myself.
Ya podrías haberme dicho que no habías tenido tiempo: lo habría hecho yo.

Jake You're right. And I needn't have printed forty copies of the report; they only wanted the summary.
Tienes razón. Y no hacía falta que imprimiera cuarenta copias del informe: solo querían el resumen.

Clara Never mind. At least we didn't need to present the budget today.
No pasa nada. Al menos hoy no hacía falta presentar el presupuesto.

Jake Do you think they may have lost interest?
¿Crees que puede que hayan perdido el interés?

Clara They might have, but they asked for a follow-up call, so I doubt it.
Puede ser, pero pidieron una llamada de seguimiento, así que lo dudo.

Jake Then it could have been worse. Lesson learnt!
Entonces podría haber sido peor. ¡Lección aprendida!

Truco del «deber» · The 'deber' trick

Cuidado con el calco: **deberías haber** (consejo tardío, crítica) → **should have**. **Debe de haber / seguro que** (deducción) → **must have**. Si en español dices **«podrías haber…»** con tono de queja → **could have** o **might have**. Y en el habla rápida oirás should've, could've, would've /ˈʃʊdəv, ˈkʊdəv, ˈwʊdəv/: ¡pero se escriben con **have**!

deberías haber → should have; debe de haber → must have; podrías haber (complaint) → could / might have.

Ejercicios · Practice

Escribe con lápiz y letra clara. Antes de escribir, piensa qué regla toca. Write in pencil. Think about the rule first.

Name · Nombre _____ Date · Fecha _____ Score _____

Ejercicio 1 Elige el modal · Choose the modal

Rodea la opción correcta. Piensa: ¿pasó o no pasó?
Circle the correct option. Did it happen or not?

1. I'm exhausted. I shouldn't have / couldn't have stayed up so late.
2. You needn't have / didn't need to bought so much food — only four people came.
3. The tickets were free, so we needn't have / didn't need to pay.
4. That was dangerous! You could have / should have fallen!
5. I don't know why she's late. She might have / should have got stuck in traffic.
6. I would have / should have lent you the money, but you never asked.
7. He couldn't have / might not have written the report: he was on holiday all month.
8. You ought / ought to have consulted a lawyer.
9. The match couldn't have / wouldn't have been more exciting.
10. Despite the snow, we could / were able to reach the village.

Ejercicio 2 Situación y comentario · Match the situation and the comment

Une cada situación con el comentario más adecuado.
Match each situation with the best comment.

1 I failed the driving test again.	a I'd have come, but nobody invited me.
2 I took an umbrella, but it didn't rain.	b You needn't have taken it.
3 Tom isn't answering his phone.	c You ought to have kept quiet.
4 I skidded on the ice and nearly crashed.	d He might have switched it off.
5 Why didn't you come to Ana's party?	e Oh, you shouldn't have!
6 EU citizens didn't need a visa.	f You should have had more lessons.
7 I told my boss exactly what I thought of him.	g So we didn't need to apply for one.
8 I brought you some flowers.	h You could have been killed!

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Ejercicios · Practice | Nivel C1

Ejercicio 3 ¿Qué expresa? · What does it express?

Clasifica cada frase: ¿crítica/reproche, especulación o (falta de) necesidad? ¡Cuidado con las trampas!

Sort the sentences: criticism, speculation or (lack of) necessity.

Word bank

- You needn't have come.
- They ought to have apologised.
- I needn't have worried.
- She didn't have to pay.
- He may not have heard.
- You might have phoned!
- They could have left already.
- I shouldn't have shouted.
- You should have asked.
- We didn't need to queue.
- She may have forgotten.
- It might have been Ana.

Crítica / reproche	Especulación	Necesidad

Ejercicio 4 Modal + have + participio · Complete with the past modal

Completa con el modal y el verbo entre paréntesis. Atención: algunas frases piden forma continua o pasiva.

Complete with the modal and the verb. Some need a continuous or passive form.

1. You look exhausted. You _____ (should / go) to bed earlier.
2. We _____ (needn't / book): the restaurant was half empty.
3. That was reckless! You _____ (could / break) your neck.
4. I can't find my keys. I _____ (might / leave) them at the office.

Ejercicio 4 Modal + have + participio · Complete with the past modal (continúa · cont.)

5. I _____ (would / phone) you, but I didn't have your number.
6. The minister _____ (ought to / resign) months ago.
7. She _____ (shouldn't / sign) the contract without reading it.
8. The report _____ (should / send) yesterday, but it's still on my desk. (pasiva)
9. You _____ (shouldn't / text) while you were driving. (continua)
10. The fire _____ (may / start) by a faulty cable. (pasiva)

Ejercicio 5 ¿Needn't have o didn't need to? · needn't have or didn't need to?

Completa con needn't have + participio (lo hice, en vano) o didn't need to + infinitivo (no lo hice).

Complete with needn't have + participle or didn't need to + infinitive.

1. I _____ (cook) so much pasta: half of it was left over.
2. The train was delayed, so we _____ (rush); we had a coffee instead.
3. We took sandwiches, but there was a buffet. We _____ (bring) them.
4. Dan already had a ticket, so he _____ (queue) and walked straight in.

Ejercicio 5 ¿Needn't have o didn't need to? · needn't have or didn't need to? (continúa · cont.)

5 You _____ (wake) me up — my alarm was set for seven anyway.

6 It was a casual event, so I _____ (wear) a suit, and I went in jeans.

7 She _____ (worry) about the interview: they offered her the job on the spot.

8 The software updated automatically, so I _____ (do) anything.

Ejercicio 6 Completa la tabla · Complete the table

✍️ Escribe la forma simple, continua y pasiva de cada modal en pasado.
Write the simple, continuous and passive forms.

Modal + verbo	Simple	Continua	Pasiva
should + check	should have checked	_____	_____
might + follow	_____	might have been following	_____
could + record	_____	_____	could have been recorded
would + watch	would have watched	_____	_____
may + monitor	_____	may have been monitoring	_____
ought to + test	_____	_____	ought to have been tested

Ejercicio 7 Ordena la frase · Put the words in order

Ordena las fichas y escribe la frase completa.
Put the words in order and write the sentence.

1. have | you | told | should | me
2. needn't | brought | you | have | anything
3. might | the | have | missed | train | she
4. been | could | the | avoided | accident | have
5. should | have | I | earlier | called | ?
6. have | to | ought | they | apologised
7. liked | have | would | I | to | come
8. been | shouldn't | you | have | texting | while driving

Ejercicio 8 ¿Pasó o no pasó? · Did it happen?

Lee la frase y decide si la afirmación es verdadera (T) o falsa (F).
Read the sentence and decide if the statement is true or false.

1. "I needn't have bought a ticket." → I bought a ticket. T F
2. "I didn't need to buy a ticket." → I definitely bought a ticket. T F
3. "You should have phoned." → You phoned. T F
4. "She shouldn't have resigned." → She resigned. T F
5. "They could have won." → They won. T F
6. "He may have left." → The speaker knows he has left. T F
7. "I'd have liked to see the exhibition." → I saw the exhibition. T F
8. "The launch couldn't have gone better." → The launch went extremely well. T F

Ejercicio 9 — Reacciona con un modal · React with a past modal

✍️ Escribe una frase con el modal entre paréntesis que comente la situación.
🇬🇧 Write a sentence with the modal in brackets.

1. Tom didn't wear a helmet and hurt his head. **(should)**
2. I took a jumper, but it was boiling. **(needn't)**
3. You didn't tell me about the party. I'm annoyed! **(might)**
4. Maybe Sara forgot about the meeting. **(may)**
5. It was possible for them to win, but they lost. **(could)**
6. It was wrong of me to lie to her. **(shouldn't)**
7. I wanted to help, but I was abroad. **(would)**
8. It wasn't necessary for us to take a taxi, so we walked. **(didn't need)**

Ejercicio 10 — Transformaciones clave · Key word transformations (C1 Advanced)

✍️ Completa la segunda frase para que signifique lo mismo que la primera. Usa la palabra clave sin cambiarla y entre 3 y 6 palabras.
🇬🇧 Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the key word and 3–6 words.

1. It was a mistake to sell the house.
   We _____ the house. (SHOULD)
2. It wasn't necessary for you to bring wine, but thanks!
   You _____ wine, but thanks! (NEED)
3. Perhaps Laura didn't get my message.
   Laura _____ my message. (MIGHT)
4. Why didn't you tell me you were in town?
   You _____ you were in town! (COULD)
5. It's a pity I didn't see the eclipse.
   I _____ the eclipse. (LIKED)

Ejercicio 10 — Transformaciones clave · Key word transformations (C1 Advanced) (continúa · cont.)

6 Helping her was the right thing to do, but I didn't.
I _____ her. (OUGHT)

7 Luckily nobody was hurt, but it was a real possibility.
Somebody _____ hurt. (BEEN)

8 It's possible that the documents were stolen.
The documents _____ stolen. (MAY)

9 It's impossible that it was Pedro: he was in Lima.
It _____ Pedro: he was in Lima. (COULDN'T)

Ejercicio 11 — Caza el error · Find the mistake

Cada frase tiene UN error. Escríbela correctamente.
Each sentence has ONE mistake. Write it correctly.

1 ✗ You must have told me earlier! I'd have helped.
✓

2 ✗ She should has called the police.
✓

3 ✗ I needn't to have worried.
✓

4 ✗ We could have went by train.
✓

5 ✗ They ought have known better.
✓

6 ✗ The meeting should have be cancelled.
✓

7 ✗ I would have like to meet her.
✓

8 ✗ Luckily, we could catch the last bus.
✓

Ejercicio 12 Lee y contesta · Read and answer

Lee el artículo de opinión. Marca T (verdadero) o F (falso) y contesta las preguntas.
Read the opinion column. Tick T or F and answer the questions.

Opinion: a disaster that should never have happened

Last November's floods in the valley were not simply bad luck. Engineers had been warning the council for years that the river defences were inadequate, and the authorities ought to have acted on those warnings long before the storm arrived.

The council insists it could not have foreseen such extreme rainfall. That may be true, but a basic maintenance programme would have reduced the damage considerably. Several residents told this newspaper that the drains had not been cleared for months; some of the flooding might have been avoided altogether.

To its credit, the council did evacuate the care home in time — although, as it turned out, the residents needn't have been moved: the water never reached the building. Meanwhile, many families in the lower streets didn't need to be told to leave: they had seen the water rising and had already gone. What the council should have done is listen. Next time, it might not be so lucky.

1 The council had been warned about the river defences. T F

2 The writer believes the floods were just bad luck. T F

3 According to the writer, what ought the authorities to have done?

Ejercicio 12 Lee y contesta · Read and answer (continúa · cont.)

4 What would have reduced the damage considerably?

5 The care home residents were moved unnecessarily. T F

6 Why didn't the families in the lower streets need to be told to leave?

7 Find a sentence that speculates about the past.

8 What does the writer think the council should have done?

Ejercicio 13 Traduce al inglés · Translate into English

Traduce. Piensa: ¿crítica, necesidad, posibilidad perdida, especulación o resultado hipotético?
Translate into English.

1 Deberías habérmelo dicho antes.

2 No hacía falta que trajeras nada, pero gracias.

3 Puede que hayan perdido el vuelo.

MODALES EN PASADO

Past modals · crítica, arrepentimiento y especulación

✏️ Ejercicios · Practice | Nivel C1

Ejercicio 13 — Traduce al inglés · Translate into English

(continúa · cont.)

4 🇪🇸 ¡Podrías haberme avisado!

🇬🇧 _____

5 🇪🇸 No debería haber dicho eso en la reunión.

🇬🇧 _____

6 🇪🇸 Me habría gustado conocer a tus padres.

🇬🇧 _____

7 🇪🇸 El accidente se podría haber evitado.

🇬🇧 _____

8 🇪🇸 No tuvimos que esperar: la consulta estaba vacía.

🇬🇧 _____

9 🇪🇸 El Gobierno debería haber actuado antes.

🇬🇧 _____

Ejercicio 14 — Ahora escribe tú · Your turn

✍️ Escribe sobre tu experiencia con modales en pasado.

🇬🇧 Write about your own experience using past modals.

1 Escribe dos cosas de las que te **arrepientes**. (should have / shouldn't have)

_____

_____

2 Cuenta algo que hiciste y que **no hacía falta**. (needn't have)

_____

_____

3 Un amigo no se presentó a una cena. **Especula** con tres explicaciones. (might / may / could have)

_____

_____

_____

4 Escribe un **reproche** educado a un compañero que no te avisó de un cambio. (could have / might have)

_____

_____

¿Lo he aprendido? · Can I do it?

Marca cada frase cuando la sepas hacer y colorea las estrellas. Tick each line when you can do it and colour the stars.

Lo sé hacer · I can...

- [ ] Critico y lamento con **should have / ought to have**. ☆☆☆
  I can criticise and express regret with should have / ought to have.
- [ ] Distingo **needn't have done** (lo hice) de **didn't need to do** (no lo hice). ☆☆☆
  I can distinguish needn't have done and didn't need to do.
- [ ] Uso **could have** para oportunidades perdidas y reproches. ☆☆☆
  I can use could have for missed chances and reproaches.
- [ ] Especulo con **might / may / could have** y sé que **couldn't have** = imposible. ☆☆☆
  I can speculate with might / may / could have.
- [ ] Expreso lo que habría pasado con **would have** y **I'd have liked to**. ☆☆☆
  I can say what would have happened.
- [ ] Manejo la forma continua y la pasiva: should have **been** + -ing / participio. ☆☆☆
  I can use continuous and passive past modals.
- [ ] Nunca escribo ~~should of~~, ~~should had~~ ni ~~must have~~ para criticar. ☆☆☆
  I never write should of, should had or must have for criticism.

Mi progreso · My progress

Colorea 1, 2 o 3 estrellas en cada ejercicio. Colour 1, 2 or 3 stars for each exercise.

Ej. 1 ☆☆☆	Ej. 2 ☆☆☆	Ej. 3 ☆☆☆	Ej. 4 ☆☆☆
Ej. 5 ☆☆☆	Ej. 6 ☆☆☆	Ej. 7 ☆☆☆	Ej. 8 ☆☆☆
Ej. 9 ☆☆☆	Ej. 10 ☆☆☆	Ej. 11 ☆☆☆	Ej. 12 ☆☆☆
Ej. 13 ☆☆☆	Ej. 14 ☆☆☆		

Solucionario · Answer key

Para el adulto que corrige (¡o para comprobar después de hacerlo!). For the grown-up who checks, or to check after you finish.

Mapa · Mini ejercicio

1. should have told · 2. needn't have bought · 3. could have won · 4. might have missed / may have missed / could have missed · 5. would have liked

Ejercicio 1 · Elige el modal

1. shouldn't have · 2. needn't have · 3. didn't need to · 4. could have · 5. might have · 6. would have · 7. couldn't have · 8. ought to · 9. couldn't have · 10. were able to

Ejercicio 2 · Situación y comentario

1-f · 2-b · 3-d · 4-h · 5-a · 6-g · 7-c · 8-e

Ejercicio 3 · ¿Qué expresa?

Crítica / reproche: You should have asked., I shouldn't have shouted., They ought to have apologised., You might have phoned!
Especulación: She may have forgotten., It might have been Ana., They could have left already., He may not have heard.
Necesidad: You needn't have come., We didn't need to queue., I needn't have worried., She didn't have to pay.

Ejercicio 4 · Modal + have + participio

1. should have gone · 2. needn't have booked · 3. could have broken · 4. might have left · 5. would have phoned · 6. ought to have resigned · 7. shouldn't have signed · 8. should have been sent · 9. shouldn't have been texting · 10. may have been started

Ejercicio 5 · ¿Needn't have o didn't need to?

1. needn't have cooked · 2. didn't need to rush · 3. needn't have brought

Ejercicio 5 · ¿Needn't have o didn't need to? (continúa · cont.)

4. didn't need to queue · 5. needn't have woken · 6. didn't need to wear · 7. needn't have worried · 8. didn't need to do

Ejercicio 6 · Completa la tabla

Modal + verbo	Simple	Continua	Pasiva
should + check	should have checked	should have been checking	should have been checked
might + follow	might have followed	might have been following	might have been followed
could + record	could have recorded	could have been recording	could have been recorded
would + watch	would have watched	would have been watching	would have been watched
may + monitor	may have monitored	may have been monitoring	may have been monitored
ought to + test	ought to have tested	ought to have been testing	ought to have been tested

Ejercicio 7 · Ordena la frase

1. You should have told me.
2. You needn't have brought anything.
3. She might have missed the train.
4. The accident could have been avoided.
5. Should I have called earlier?
6. They ought to have apologised.
7. I would have liked to come.
8. You shouldn't have been texting while driving.

MODALES EN PASADO

Past modals · crítica, arrepentimiento y especulación

Solucionario · Answer key | **Nivel C1**

Ejercicio 8 · ¿Pasó o no pasó?

1. True ✓ — Needn't have = lo hice, pero no hacía falta.
2. False ✗ — Normalmente significa que no lo compró.
3. False ✗ — Should have = no lo hiciste.
4. True ✓ — Shouldn't have = lo hizo y fue un error.
5. False ✗ — Could have = posible, pero no ocurrió.
6. False ✗ — Es una especulación.
7. False ✗ — Deseo frustrado: no la vi.
8. True ✓ — Couldn't have + comparativo = enfático.

Ejercicio 9 · Reacciona con un modal

1. He should have worn a helmet.
2. I needn't have taken a jumper.
3. You might have told me about the party!
4. Sara may have forgotten about the meeting.
5. They could have won.
6. I shouldn't have lied to her.
7. I would have helped, but I was abroad.
8. We didn't need to take a taxi, so we walked.

Ejercicio 10 · Transformaciones clave

1. shouldn't have sold / should not have sold
2. needn't have brought / need not have brought
3. might not have got / might not have received
4. could have told me
5. would have liked to see / would have liked to have seen
6. ought to have helped
7. could have been / might have been
8. may have been
9. couldn't have been

Ejercicio 11 · Caza el error

1. You should have told me earlier! I'd have helped.
2. She should have called the police.
3. I needn't have worried.
4. We could have gone by train.
5. They ought to have known better.
6. The meeting should have been cancelled.
7. I would have liked to meet her.
8. Luckily, we were able to catch the last bus. / Luckily, we managed to catch the last bus.

Ejercicio 12 · Lee y contesta

1. True ✓
2. False ✗ — "The floods were not simply bad luck."
3. They ought to have acted on the engineers' warnings before the storm arrived.
4. A basic maintenance programme.
5. True ✓ — They needn't have been moved: the water never reached the building.
6. Because they had seen the water rising and had already gone.
7. "Some of the flooding might have been avoided altogether."
8. It should have listened (to the warnings).

Ejercicio 13 · Traduce al inglés

1. You should have told me before. / You should have told me earlier.
2. You needn't have brought anything, but thank you.
3. They may have missed the flight. / They might have missed the flight.
4. You could have warned me! / You might have warned me!
5. I shouldn't have said that in the meeting.
6. I would have liked to meet your parents.
7. The accident could have been avoided.
8. We didn't need to wait: the surgery was empty. / We didn't have to wait: the surgery was empty.
9. The government should have acted earlier. / The government ought to have acted sooner.

Ejercicio 14 · Ahora escribe tú

1. Ej.: I should have studied abroad when I had the chance. I shouldn't have sold my old guitar.
2. Ej.: I needn't have printed my boarding pass: the airline accepted the one on my phone.
3. Ej.: He might have got lost. He may have forgotten. His train could have been cancelled.
4. Ej.: You could have let me know the meeting had been moved — I'd have prepared the slides.